

Narain, Lal Bahadur Shastri and Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyay were the real leaders of the masses who truly made austerity their way of life. The mock austerity of Sonia Gandhi and son Rahul is nothing but a cruel joke played on the poor people of India.

A.K. SHARMA,
Chandigarh

The Congress-led UPA Government has enacted a total farce by forcing its ministers to become austere. UPA 2.0 is merely trying to showcase themselves to be in solidarity with the people of the country who are already torn and tattered by multiple worries which are only the result of their poor governance. In fact, they have imposed a forced austerity on people. The Swiss bank accounts of these politicians may just prove how austere they really are. People are not as vengeful as our *netas*. They only want our politicians to do things they have been voted for.

DINESH CHANDER,
Chennai

Banking on Hope

It is rather unfortunate to read about the exodus forced on the Hindus residing in border areas of Pakistan with the condition either to embrace Islam or getting abducted for their refusal ("The Nowhere People", October

5). Our politicians should take a cue from here and look into the matter as soon as possible.

RAMESH AGARWAL,
Kanpur

Celebrating India

From time to time, the Ministry of Tourism (MOT) showcases India in different foreign cities in order to attract tourists which is indeed laudable



VIJAYANAND GUPTA

“In the absence of a clear-cut ideology and a common minimum programme of the Third Front, the battle in Maharashtra will be between the Congress-NCP and BJP-Shiv Sena alliances.”

K.R. SRINIVASAN, Secunderabad

("Reaching Out to LA", October 5). But promoting tourism is one thing and measuring up to a tourist's minimum expectation is another. Apart from affordable hotels, transportation and well-trained tour guides, the most vital thing for a foreign tourist is a decent toilet facility. These are the areas where

we fall flat. The MOT must take a deeper look into these issues.

DILIP JOSHI,
Pune

Fake Factor

It is a matter of deep concern that many fake currency notes are in circulation ("Plastic Reality", October 5). The police must seize all fake notes and stop the smug-

gling of such notes into the country. Perhaps the printing of notes of higher denominations could be stopped until they are replaced by newly designed notes. In the meantime, it might make sense to print more notes of lower denominations.

M. KUMAR,
via www.indiatoday.in

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

DECEMBER 1-15, 1979

Judges Threatened

The high-domed, sandstone Supreme Court building, the nation's highest seat of justice on New Delhi's Tilak Marg is today an embattled fortress. Riot control policemen stand around, discreetly taking a low profile, while hawk-eyed securitymen scrutinise the visitors to the court. And perhaps for the first time since Independence, entry to the court rooms is regulated with passes. The transformation follows the alleged threats to the chief justice of the court, Y.V. Chandrachud, 59, who is on a three-member bench hearing appeals in the *Kissa Kursi Ka* case. Sanjay Gandhi had been convicted by a lower court along with the former information minister V.C. Shukla on charges of destroying during the Emergency the film *Kissa Kursi Ka* which they considered critical of Mrs Gandhi's regime. Phone calls were received by the wives of the chief justice and justice A.C. Gupta, who is also hearing the appeal. The caller, a male, had threatened bodily harm to the judges if they "did anything" in the case.

by Arul B. Louis



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